



×



THE BOLLES SCHOOL
BULLDOGS LACROSSE
SENIOR LEADERSHIP

BUILDING IDENTITY · ELEVATING LEADERS · EMPOWERING TEAMS

TEAM SESSION · IRONMIND ELITE × BOLLES BULLDOGS LACROSSE

11 Thoughts About Teamwork

Translated for the Bolles senior class

Jon Gordon's eleven principles of great teams, rebuilt in IronMind language for juniors and seniors who are about to run this locker room. Each thought comes with one rep you can do this week.

"We > me."

JON GORDON

11

ADAPTED FROM

Jon Gordon

The Power of a Positive Team (Wiley, 2018), "11 Thoughts About Teamwork"

YOUR COACH

Kenny Stoddart

IronMind Elite · Jon Gordon Certified
Trainer
"Coach Kenny"

SESSION

Senior Leadership

2026–27 season · Jacksonville, FL

PRIVATE — YOURS TO KEEP · WRITE IN IT

HOW TO USE THIS

Every card has three parts. **Jon's point** is the idea in plain terms. **The IronMind translation** is what it means on this team, this season. **The rep** is the thing you actually do. Reading the card is not the work. The rep is the work.

Credit where it's due. The eleven principles are Jon Gordon's, from "11 Thoughts About Teamwork" in *The Power of a Positive Team* (Wiley, 2018). The translations, examples, and reps are IronMind Elite's, written for Bolles lacrosse.

01 Five things decide the season

JON'S POINT

Teams are built or broken by culture, leadership, relationships, attitude, and effort.

IRONMIND TRANSLATION

None of those five is talent. All five are choices, and this senior class sets every one of them. Culture is what happens at practice when the coaches turn their backs.

THE REP

Rate the team 1–10 on each of the five (page 6). Take the lowest score and name one thing the seniors will do about it this week.

MY NOTE

02 Sometimes you're the star. Sometimes you set him up.

JON'S POINT

Some days you're the star. Some days your job is to help the star.

IRONMIND TRANSLATION

The ground ball, the clear, the slide that leaves you exposed so your goalie gets the save. Composure means you don't need your name on the stat sheet to know you mattered.

THE REP

After the next game, every senior calls out one teammate's unglamorous play in the huddle — by name, specifically.

MY NOTE

03 Train the teammate like you train the player

JON'S POINT

Being a great teammate takes as much work as being a great player.

IRONMIND TRANSLATION

You've put hundreds of hours into your stick. How many into being a teammate? It's trainable the same way: reps, feedback, and consistency on bad days.

THE REP

Add "teammate" to the Leadership row of your Weekly Scorecard and score it every Sunday night.

MY NOTE

04 They care about the teammate, not the highlight film

JON'S POINT

Your team cares less about whether you're a superstar than whether you're a great team member.

IRONMIND TRANSLATION

Your film gets you looked at. Your reputation in the locker room gets you trusted — and that reputation follows you to college, into every room a coach calls about you.

THE REP

Write the honest answer: "What would the freshmen say about me if I weren't in the room?"

MY NOTE

05 Three things are always yours

JON'S POINT

Every day you control your attitude, your effort, and how you act as a teammate — no matter what feels unfair around you.

IRONMIND TRANSLATION

This is Control / Influence / Release. Playing time, the officials, and the lineup go in Release. Attitude, effort, and teammate actions go in Control. Complaining about Release burns the energy you need for Control.

THE REP

When a guy starts complaining, a senior asks one question: "Which column is that in?"

MY NOTE

06 One guy can't build it. One guy can break it.

JON'S POINT

*No one person makes a team, but one person can wreck it. Don't let negative energy — his "Energy Vampires," from *The Energy Bus* — take over.*

IRONMIND TRANSLATION

At 17 the drain looks like eye-rolling in a drill, the group chat after a loss, the sideline sulk. This is never about labeling a teammate or freezing him out. Start with the mirror — am I the drain today? If it's someone else: early, small, private.

THE REP

Seniors pick one reset phrase to call each other back (page 6). It names the behavior, never the person.

MY NOTE

07 Players enforce the standard

JON'S POINT

Great teammates hold each other to the high standard their culture expects.

IRONMIND TRANSLATION

If only the coaches enforce the standard, you have rules. When players enforce it, you have a culture. And when it's your turn to get called out, take it cleanly: "You're right. Here's what I'm changing."

THE REP

Each senior reads his three standards from the Captain's Standard Sheet out loud to the group.

MY NOTE

08 A real team beats a pile of talent

JON'S POINT

Talent loses to a real team when the talent doesn't play as one.

IRONMIND TRANSLATION

You've seen the roster full of commits fall apart in the third quarter. Talent is what you have. Team is what you do with it — and it shows up most when the game gets ugly.

THE REP

In film, find one goal that came from six guys each doing their job — not one guy doing everything.

MY NOTE

09 Great teams care more

JON'S POINT

The best teams care more — about their effort, their work, and each other.

IRONMIND TRANSLATION

Care is visible. Who stays to pick up balls. Who knows the backup goalie's name. Who texts the injured guy. Care is one of the three places authority comes from: competence, consistency, care.

THE REP

This week, check in with one teammate outside the starting lineup — and not about lacrosse.

MY NOTE

10 We > me

JON'S POINT

Unity is the difference between great and average. United teams are selfless and put the team first.

IRONMIND TRANSLATION

Senior year pulls toward "me" harder than any other year — recruiting, stats, commitments, what's next. That's normal. The job is to hold both: chase your future and still put the team first between the lines.

THE REP

Write down one "me" thing you're willing to give up for the "we" (page 7).

MY NOTE

11 The fork in the road, every day

JON'S POINT

Every day your team chooses between settling for average and chasing greatness.

IRONMIND TRANSLATION

Greatness isn't the speech before the rival game. It's the 6:15 lift in the rain. You don't make this choice once in preseason. You make it on an ordinary Tuesday.

THE REP

**Every session ends with the same question: "Which road did we take this week?"
One word from each senior (page 7).**

MY NOTE

THE STANDING QUESTION

Which road did we take this week?

Eleven thoughts, one test. Ask it every week, answer it honestly, and don't let the answer be a speech. **The road you take on an ordinary Tuesday is the team you are in May.**

THE ONE THOUGHT FROM THESE ELEVEN THAT HIT ME HARDEST — AND WHY

Where we are right now

Fill this in during the session. Honest beats impressive.

THOUGHT 01 — THE FIVE	1-10	WHAT THE SENIORS WILL DO ABOUT IT THIS WEEK
Culture		
Leadership		
Relationships		
Attitude		
Effort		

THOUGHT 05 — WHICH COLUMN IS IT IN?

CONTROL Attitude, effort, how I treat teammates. _____ _____ _____	INFLUENCE I can move it, not decide it. _____ _____ _____	RELEASE Playing time, officials, the lineup. _____ _____ _____
---	--	---

THOUGHT 06 — OUR RESET PHRASE (NAMES THE BEHAVIOR, NEVER THE PERSON)

THOUGHT 04 — WHAT WOULD THE FRESHMEN SAY ABOUT ME IF I WEREN'T IN THE ROOM?

What I'm committing to

Keep this page. We come back to it every week.

THOUGHT 10 — ONE "ME" THING I'M WILLING TO GIVE UP FOR THE "WE"

THOUGHT 09 — THE TEAMMATE OUTSIDE THE STARTING LINEUP I'LL CHECK IN WITH THIS WEEK

THOUGHT 11 — WHICH ROAD DID WE TAKE?

WEEK

ONE WORD — AND WHY

Session 1

Session 2

Session 3

Session 4

MY ONE REP FROM THESE ELEVEN — THE ONE I'LL ACTUALLY DO

BY WHEN

HOW WE'LL KNOW

Adapted from Gordon, J. (2018). *The power of a positive team: Proven principles and practices that make great teams great*. Wiley. "11 Thoughts About Teamwork." Principles paraphrased with attribution; IronMind translations, examples, and exercises © 2026 IronMind Advisors.